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Best music oriented IEMs you can buy under 2k

Whether you're taking your first steps into the audiophile arena or just want the best pair of in-ears for your daily commute, you'll find them all here.

Siddharth Parwatay
siddharth.parwatay.digit.in

Cowon EM1

The EM1 has been our go-to recommendation in the budget space for nearly two years now. A total workhorse, the EM1 can take some rough handling. The audio quality for the price delivers the best proposition you can find. What the headphone lacks in terms of precision it makes



up in comfort and isolation. The fit and isolation is one of the best we've seen. If you can get your hands on one (since they frequently go out of stock everywhere), they're a perfect balance between value and performance.

Price: ₹675 (mic-less version)

Creative EP-630

At one time, the EP-630 had sent Indian forums in a tizzy for the kind of phenomenal price to performance it offered. It was how first time listeners witnessed great audio in the IEM form factor. Sure in today's day and age they don't offer the flat tangle free cables that the likes of the EM1 do, but hey has their aural performance degraded over the years? Of course not! Classics never go out of style. Pick them up for their distinct bass heavy and yet



ultra sharp sound signature (and a hint of nostalgia too).

Price: ₹700

Tekfusion Ecoofers

The budget variant of the Twinwoofers, but surprisingly not too budget-sounding. The set itself looks a little different from the average IEM, owing to the wood finish on the ear buds. We also liked the flat cables that were used, ensuring a rela-



tively tangle-free experience. The Ecoofers are powered by twin 10mm drivers and have a frequency response of 18 - 20,000 Hz but of course as experience teaches us, specifications don't mean squat as much as real-world performance. Go for the Ecoofers if you want to be different from the pack and don't want to go for the ultra-common EP-630 types.

Price: ₹850

Sennheiser CX180 Street II

The CX 180 has one of the most pleasing sound signatures out there. Not too boomy, and not too shrill, it manages to hit the goldilocks spot of "just right" quite well. It's also for those who can't do



without the Sennheiser sound. We particularly like the steel grey variant with its signature ultra small housing.

Price: ₹948

Xiaomi's Mi (Piston)

There's no denying that at ₹799, the Mi earphones are a fantastic deal. The overall performance, build quality and design make these a very good buy and another successful product from the Mi

